



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Covenant Christian High School

School Website: <https://cchsnw.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Classicality Audit Report: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX)

School website used: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (ACS) clearly and consistently articulates a classical, Christian philosophy and practice. Its public materials emphasize transcendental moral realism ("truth, goodness, and beauty"), the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, a Trivium-shaped curriculum with Latin, logic, and rhetoric, and a pedagogy that includes memorization/recitation in the Grammar years, debate/discussion and formal rhetoric with thesis work in the upper grades. ACS is explicitly grounded in theology through a robust sequence of Christian Studies (Exegesis & Hermeneutics; Applied Exegesis; Apologetics & Ethics) and daily Chapel, and it intentionally "co-labors" with parents in a collaborative model. On our six-category classicality framework, ACS scores CLASSICAL in five categories and SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Faculty (the only area where the public site offers fewer explicit signals about a formal "portrait" of the teacher and collegial faculty culture).

Key evidence: - Mission and aim: "cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students" and teach through the "contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful". - Trivium-centered curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Latin study, Great Books/Great Conversation language; integration of knowledge under theology. - Theology and liturgy: Christian Studies sequence (Exegesis, Apologetics), daily Chapel and "All School chapel" for visitors. - Pedagogy: memorization, recitation, songs in lower school; debate/discussion in Logic stage; rhetoric with thesis defense in upper school. - Parents/community: collaborative model with co-teachers; prospective parent meetings and tours (with chapel), open campus rhythms; strong community life (athletics, theater, Recitatio).

Reference framework: Positive/negative keyword indicators and category criteria from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the classicality lexicon were used to ground keyword matching and scoring across all six categories.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS — CLASSICAL

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on ACS site: - "glorify Jesus Christ"; "classical, Christian education"; "goodness, truth, and beauty" shaping imagination; "wise, virtuous, and humble students". - Theology and worship: Christian Studies sequence (Development of Christian Doctrine; Exegesis & Hermeneutics; Applied Exegesis; Apologetics & Ethics); daily "Chapel"; visitors attend "All School chapel". - Comparison to positive/negative indicators: - Positive matches include: "truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom" (transcendental moral realism), "theology; sacred scripture; doctrine; catechesis" (grounded in theology), and "liturgy/chapel; prayer; hymnody/choir" (liturgical practices) per the Six Elements keyword lists and lexicon. - No negative signals like "values-neutral," "religiously neutral," or "pluralistic approach" were found. - Quantification: - Positive hits: 15 (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom; theology courses; chapel/All School chapel; prayer; Christ-centered language, etc.) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage of sub-elements: 3/3 (TGB/virtue; theology; liturgy/communal worship) = 1.00 - Justification:

ACS explicitly affirms transcendental moral realism, is deeply grounded in theology in the curriculum, and practices communal worship. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL — CLASSICAL

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found: - “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (aim), “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful,” “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”. - Formation of the person: “helping form the souls of our children... daily pointed to the good, true, and beautiful”. - Comparison to positive/negative indicators: - Positive matches: “wisdom, virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation not information” per Six Elements. - ACS explicitly de-emphasizes “college preparatory” as the ultimate telos (counter to “workforce prep” language) ; no negative signals like “21st-century skills” dominance or “career readiness” as end. - Quantification: - Positive hits: 9 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage of sub-elements: 3/3 (virtue/wisdom as aim; formation; TGB) = 1.00 - Justification: Aims and language align tightly with classical purposes. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM — CLASSICAL

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found: - Trivium (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric), Latin, formal logic, rhetoric; history (not “social studies”); Great Books/Great Conversation; interrelation of all knowledge under theology. - Upper School plan includes Latin, Logic, Rhetoric, Philosophy; Christian Studies sequence; extensive literature/history lineup. - Comparison to positive/negative indicators: - Positive matches: “Trivium; Latin; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; integrated approach; history as history” per Six Elements/lexicon. - No negative signals like “social studies replacing history,” “STEM-first framing,” or “project-based learning dominance” (a single “National History Day Project” mention is not the same as a dominant pedagogy). - Quantification: - Positive hits: 12 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage of sub-elements: 3/4 observed (Trivium; history-as-history; Great Books/Conversation; “wonder” not explicitly named) = 0.75 - Justification: Strong Trivium/Latin/Great Books/Integration signals across divisions; minor gap is explicit “wonder” terminology. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS) — CLASSICAL

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found: - Grammar years: “memorization, recitation, and songs”. - Logic stage: “debate and discussion” as chief modes of learning. - Rhetoric stage: “Thesis defense and eloquent written and oral communication” (rhetoric training). - Comparison to positive/negative indicators: - Positive matches: “recitation/chanting/singing,” “debate/discussion (dialectic),” “rhetoric/oratory” (aligned to lexicon and Six Elements pedagogy). - “Scholé/restful” is not explicitly named; no negative “experiential/project-based-only/student-directed” emphasis appears. - Quantification: - Positive hits: 8 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage of sub-elements: 3/4 (Lower school memory/chanting; dialectic discussion; rhetoric/orations; restful learning not explicit) = 0.75 - Justification: Clear classical pedagogy across stages; lack of explicit scholé language is the only gap. Rating: CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found: - Teachers are “professed Christians,” “model proper behavior,” “model the pursuit of knowledge in a humble way,” are “good subject-matter experts,”

and receive training/observation and “ongoing educational opportunities”; day begins with Chapel for students and teachers. - Comparison to positive/negative indicators: - Positive matches: “teachers as models of virtue,” “formation through example,” and signs of professional formation (training/observations) align with Six Elements faculty ideals; however, the public site offers less explicit language about a formal “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” or a collegial, seminar-driven faculty culture compared to the lexicon’s stronger signals for faculty collegium/mentorship. - No negative signals (e.g., purely facilitator/technique-driven jargon) are present. - Quantification: - Positive hits: 6 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage: ~0.50 against the category’s richer benchmarks (model teachers = strong; portrait/collegium/living curriculum = not plainly articulated) - Justification: Strong moral/exemplary expectations for teachers are present, but the site is thinner on formal faculty culture artifacts (e.g., published Portrait of a Teacher or explicit collegial/mentoring structures). Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY — CLASSICAL

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found: - “co-laboring with families” (mission); collaborative model with “co-teachers” (parents partner closely with classroom teachers who provide curriculum/lesson plans); parents frequently invited: campus tours include “All School chapel,” prospective parent meetings include chapel and leadership talks; community events (athletics/theater/Recitatio) draw families together. - Comparison to positive/negative indicators: - Positive matches: “parent partnership/co-educators,” “parent formation meetings,” “open campus/hospitality” per lexicon and Six Elements community practices. - No negative “parent as customer only” signals identified. - Quantification: - Positive hits: 8 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage: ~0.90 (partnership/co-teaching strongly explicit; parent education via meetings evident; openness is structured via regular tours/meetings and chapel) - Justification: ACS’s collaborative model and hospitality practices strongly align with classical parent/community ideals. Rating: CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Rating

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (1.00 positive; coverage 1.00)
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL (1.00 positive; coverage 1.00)
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL (1.00 positive; coverage 0.75)
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL (1.00 positive; coverage 0.75)
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (1.00 positive; coverage ~0.50)
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL (1.00 positive; coverage ~0.90)

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Additional institutional context: - ACCS accreditation, spring 2025, further supports alignment with classical Christian standards.

What would move the needle (Faculty)

Because Faculty is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” (and “Portrait of a Graduate”) that explicitly names virtues, habits of mind, and collegial expectations (Socratic collegium, life-long learning, faculty seminars) to align with Six Elements’ faculty ideals. - Publicly describe faculty formation rhythms (e.g., regular great-books seminars for teachers; classical pedagogy training; mentorship/apprenticeship for new faculty) using classical vocabulary from the lexicon (e.g., “faculty of friends,” “collegium,” “master-apprentice”). - Share exemplars of faculty-led liturgical/recitation practices or teacher scholarship (papers, talks, in-house colloquia) to make the culture visible.

Evidence Appendix (selected)

- Classical Education Basics: “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty ... cultivate wisdom and virtue ... Great Books ... Great Conversation ... Trivium”.
 - Educational approach and Trivium explanation; integrated knowledge under theology; Bible and great works; Latin/logic/rhetoric; memory and reasoning emphases.
 - Upper School course map: Christian Studies (Exegesis, Apologetics), Logic, Rhetoric, Philosophy; thesis and eloquence.
 - Chapel: daily practice; tours include “All School chapel”.
 - Collaborative model and teacher expectations; parent partnership.
 - Reference lexicon and Six Elements positive/negative keyword lists used for scoring.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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